

What is the RIGHT ATTITUDE *for* MEDITATION?

Ashin Tejaniya

1

Meditating is *acknowledging* and *observing* whatever happens – whether pleasant or unpleasant – in a *relaxed* way.

2

Meditating is watching and waiting patiently with *awareness & understanding*.

Meditation is NOT *trying* to experience something you have read or heard about.

3

Just pay attention to *the present moment.*

Don't get lost in thoughts about the past.

Don't get carried away by thoughts about the future.

4

When meditating, both the mind and the body should be *comfortable.*

5

If the mind and the body are getting ***tired***, something is wrong with the way you are practising, and it is time to *check* the way you are meditating.

6

Why do you focus so hard when you meditate?

Do you want something?

Do you want something to happen?

Do you want something to stop happening?

Check to see if one of these attitudes is present.

7

The meditating mind should be *relaxed* and *at peace*. You ***cannot*** practise when the mind is tense.

8

Don't focus too hard, don't control. Neither force nor restrict yourself.

9

Don't try to create anything, and don't reject what is happening.

Just be aware.

10

Trying to create something is greed.

Rejecting what is happening is aversion.

Not knowing if something is happening or has stopped happening is delusion.

11

The less greed, aversion and anxiety the observing mind has, the *easier* it is to meditate.

12

Don't have any expectations, don't want anything, don't be anxious, because if these attitudes are in your mind, it becomes difficult to meditate.

13

You are not trying to make things turn out the way you want them to happen.

You are trying to *know* what is happening *as it is.*

14

What is the mind doing?
Thinking? Being aware?

15

Where is the mind now?
Inside? Outside?

16

Is the watching or observing
mind *properly aware*
or only superficially aware?

17

Don't practise with a mind that wants something or wants something to happen. The result will only be that you tire yourself out.

18

You have to accept and watch *both* good and bad experiences.

You want only good experiences?

You don't want even the tiniest unpleasant experience?

Is that reasonable?

Is this the way of the Dhamma?

19

You have to double check to see what attitude you are meditating with. A light and free mind enables you to meditate well.

Do you have the right attitude?

20

Don't feel disturbed by the thinking mind. You are not practising to prevent thinking; but rather to *recognize* and *acknowledge* thinking whenever it arises.

21

Don't reject any object that comes to your attention. Get to know the defilements that arise in relation to the object and keep *examining* the defilements.

22

The object of attention is not really important; the *observing mind* that is working in the background to be aware is of real importance. If the observing is done with the right attitude, *any* object is the right object.

23

Only when there is *faith* or *confidence* (saddhā), **effort** will arise.

Only when there is *effort* (viriya), **mindfulness** will become continuous.

Only when *mindfulness* (sati) is continuous, **stability of mind** will become established.

When you start
understanding things as
they are (paññā),
faith will grow stronger.

Only when *stability*
of mind (samādhi) is
established, you will start
understanding things
as they are.



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